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Water transport is the process of moving people, goods etc. by barge, boat, ship or sailboat over a sea, ocean, lake, canal, river, etc. This category does not include articles on the transport of water for the purpose of consuming the water. Water Transports are of two types

(i) Inland Waterways ii). Ocean Waterways

(i) Inland Waterways

Inland Waterways comprise of rivers, canals and lakes. It is also known as internal water transport. Rivers that are naturally navigable are called natural waterways. Canals and canalized rivers belong to the category of 'Artificial Waterways'. Generally small boats and steamers are operated on rivers to transport people and goods. Where rivers are deep enough, large ships can also ply on them. Canals are man-made waterways, constructed for the twin purposes of navigation and irrigation.



Boat-House



Yatch

Advantages of inland waterways

a) It is considered as the cheapest mode of transport among the other modes of transport.

b) It carries goods smoothly due to the absence of shaking and jolting during transit. It is eminently suitable for the carriage of fragile goods like glassware, earth ware etc., without causing damage.

c) It is most suitable for heavy loads.

d) There is lesser pollution in water transport.

e) Initial investment on river services as well as expenditure on their maintenance is much lesser as compared to road and rail transport.

Disadvantages of inland waterways

a) It is the slowest means of transport. As compared to this, railways are quicker, safer and cheaper means of transport.

b) Floods caused during rainy season, lack of flow of water during summer season affect to ply boats and steamers.

c) Sometimes rivers also change their way. It leads to stoppage and uncertainty in usage of this means of transport.

(ii) Ocean or Sea Transport

Ocean transport has been playing a significant role in development of economic, social and cultural relations among countries of the world. International trade owes its growth to ocean transport. Ocean transport enjoys a pride of place in aiding international trade. Cheapness is its great virtue. In the transportation of low-grade, bulky goods among the countries, the role of ocean transport is commendable.